

Lumina — helping learners actually finish the course

An online-learning platform designed around completion, not just enrollment — clear progress, one-tap resume, and motivating momentum that brings learners back.

ROLE	TIMELINE	PLATFORM	TOOLS
UX / UI Designer	7 weeks	Web + Mobile	Figma · Maze · Hotjar

01

The Problem

People enroll in online courses full of intention — and rarely finish. They lose their place, lose momentum, and the dashboard does nothing to pull them back. Completion rates sit in the low double digits.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

How might we help learners maintain momentum and actually finish the courses they start?

~13%

average online-course
completion rate

#1

drop-off reason: "lost my
place / motivation"



completion when
progress & goals are
visible

Goals & Success Metrics



Effortless resume

"Continue where you left off" as the hero action, one tap away.



Visible progress

Every course shows how far along you are — and what's next.



Motivating momentum

Weekly goals & streaks that reward consistency.

Target metrics: time-to-resume < 5s · next-lesson findability > 90% · SUS > 80 · motivation ↑.

03

User Research

10 learner interviews

Survey — 52 respondents

Competitive audit — Coursera, Udemy, Duolingo

Hotjar recordings

Key findings

1

Resuming is the biggest friction

Learners abandon when they can't instantly find where they stopped.

2

Progress is motivating

Seeing "33% complete" and a shrinking to-do list pulls people forward.

3

Micro-learning fits real life

Busy learners study in short mobile bursts, not long desktop sessions.

4

Goals & streaks work

Duolingo-style weekly goals meaningfully increase return visits.

**Arjun Kumar**

27 · Developer · upskilling on the side

"I get 30 minutes between work and life. Just drop me back exactly where I stopped."

GOALS

- Resume instantly in spare moments
- See how close he is to finishing

FRUSTRATIONS

- Hunting for the next lesson
- Losing momentum after a break

**Lena Brar**

22 · Student · goal-driven learner

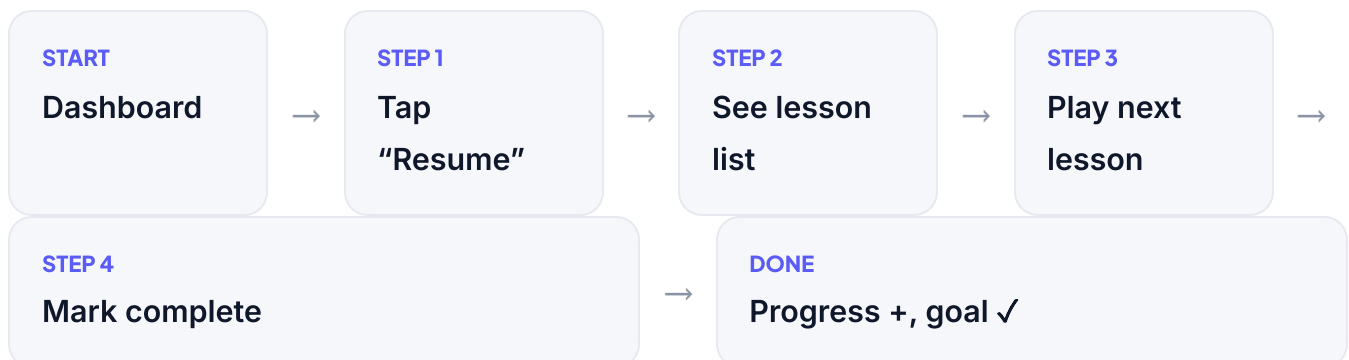
"Streaks and weekly goals are what keep me coming back — I don't want to break the chain."

GOALS

- Hit a weekly learning goal
- Feel progress & accomplishment

FRUSTRATIONS

- No sense of momentum or reward
- Flat, uninspiring dashboards

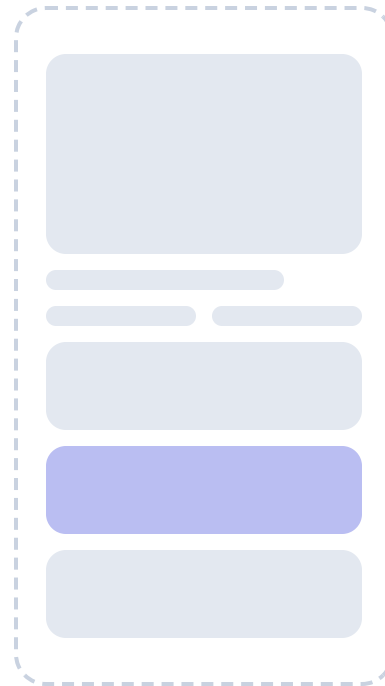


06 Wireframes

Low-fi centred the dashboard on a big “continue learning” hero, with progress and a weekly goal in view — and a mobile course page built around lesson states.



Desktop — continue hero · courses · goal



Mobile — progress + lesson states

Hi-Fi Design & Prototype

The dashboard leads with a “Continue Learning” hero (progress bar + Resume), course cards each show their progress, and a weekly-goal ring rewards consistency. The mobile course page uses clear lesson states — done, now-playing and locked.



LuminaHome

My Courses

Explore

Community

🔥 12 day streak



R

Welcome back, Rushmitha

You're on a 12-day streak — 2 lessons to reach this week's goal.

CONTINUE LEARNING

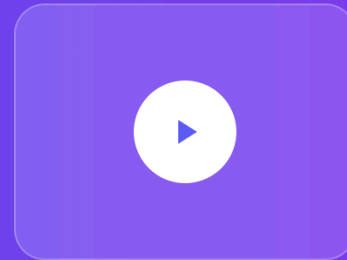
Advanced UI/UX Design System

Lesson 8 of 24 · Auto-layout & Design Tokens



33% complete · 5.2 hrs left

▶ Resume



Your Courses

[See all](#)

DESIGN

UI/UX Design Systems

Sarah Kim

33% · 8/24 lessons

DATA

Product Analytics 101

Mark Lee

60% · 12/20 lessons

Weekly Goal

5 of 7 days



2 more days to hit your goal!

Upcoming

[Calendar](#)

Live Q&A: Design Critique

Advanced UI/UX

4:00 PM

Assignment: Wireframes

Due tomorrow

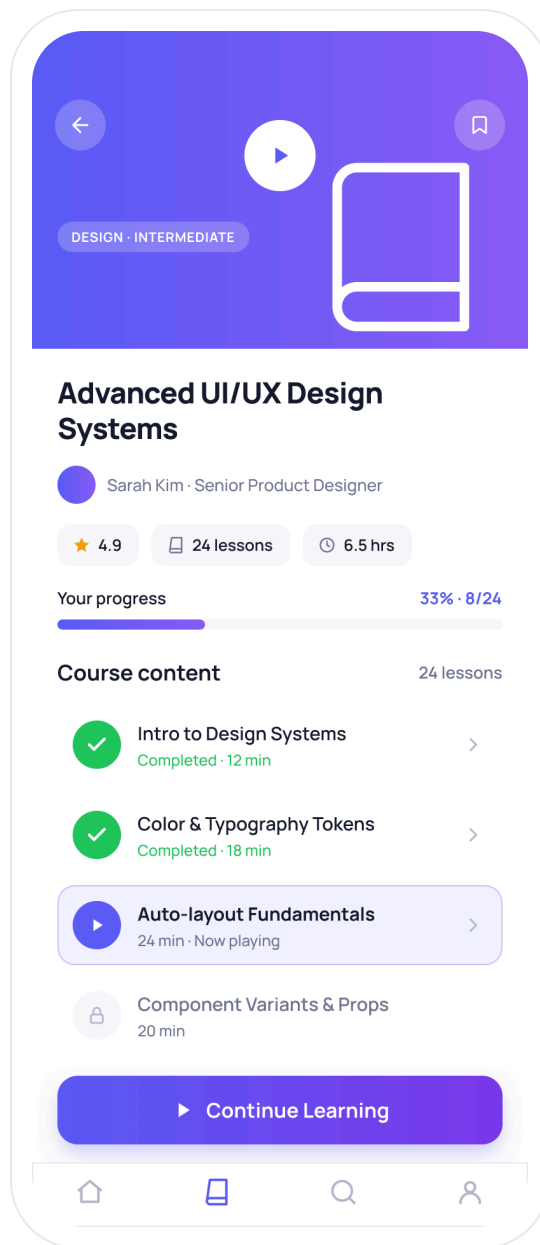
11:59 PM

New lesson unlocked

Product Analytics

Fri

Course dashboard (desktop) — continue hero, courses, weekly goal & schedule



Course detail (mobile) — progress + lesson states + Continue

Key design decisions



"Continue Learning" hero

The single most-wanted action — resume — is the biggest, clearest thing on the page.



Progress everywhere

Course cards, a completion bar and a weekly-goal ring keep momentum visible.



Lesson states

Done ✓ / now-playing / locked make “what's next” unmistakable.

Usability Testing

6 learners, moderated remote sessions.

Tasks: (1) "Resume your in-progress course." (2) "Find the next lesson to complete."

METRIC	TARGET	RESULT
Time to resume a course	< 5s	3s
Next-lesson findability	> 90%	96%
System Usability Scale	> 80	85
Motivation to continue (1–5)	↑	4.4

What testing changed

ITERATION 1

Resume competed with browsing new courses. → Made **"Continue Learning"** the **visual hero** with a clear Resume button and progress.

ITERATION 2

Learners weren't sure which lesson was next. → Strengthened **lesson states** (done / now-playing highlight / locked) so the next step is obvious.

09

Results & Impact

3s

to resume a
course (target
<5s)

96%

found the next
lesson

85

SUS score

4.4/5

motivation to
keep learning

10

Reflection & Next Steps

Completion is a **design problem, not a content problem**. Making “resume” frictionless and progress visible did more for momentum than any feature. Borrowing habit mechanics (goals, streaks) from Duolingo translated well to structured courses.

Next: smart reminders after a lapse, downloadable lessons for offline micro-learning, and certificates/celebrations at milestones.

UX Research

Behavioural Design

Information Architecture

Responsive Design

Usability Testing